



A City In Full Swing

Forget the checklist. In New Orleans, the best moments arrive with a horn section, a dusting of powdered sugar, and a drink in a to-go cup.

There's a track for every city, but New Orleans beats to a rhythm that embodies a symphony of sounds. Over three centuries, the Crescent City has inculcated a rich blend of history, culture, and architecture. Every stone, restaurant, and jazz band has a story that can captivate anyone willing to listen.

Founded by Jean-Baptiste Le Moyne de Bienville in 1718 on a bend of the Mississippi, the city was taken over by the Spanish, who rebuilt the French Quarter into the iconic courtyards that thrive today. A brief reclamation by the French, followed by its acquisition by the United States later, New Orleans had already established layers of history that produced a Creole culture unlike any other, laying the foundation for the melting pot of cultures that the city represents today.

RHYTHM & BLUES

Congo Square marks the spot where the enslaved and free people of colour gathered to drum and dance, giving birth to jazz — the heart of the city and also the birthplace of the genre. Every club, bar, and restaurant echoes with jazz, keeping the legacy alive with the French Quarter Festival, Satchmo SummerFest, and the Jazz & Heritage Festival. Historic rooms honour legendary greats such as Louis Armstrong, Buddy Bolden, and Sidney Bechet.

For the full effect, head to Frenchmen Street in the Marigny, where Snug Harbor, d.b.a., and the Spotted Cat sit within strolling distance. With any luck, a visit to the Blue Nile may even include a performance by Kermit Ruffins and the BBQ Swingers.



It's impossible to talk about New Orleans without a mention of the storied Mardi Gras, the exuberant send-off before Lent that's grown into a citywide spectacle of towering floats, masked balls, king cake, and costumed revelry, with music and art spilling into every street.

CULINARY DELIGHTS

New Orleans takes its food seriously. In 2025, *Time Out* named the city the world's best food destination, and its 1,000-plus eateries offer delicious evidence.

Start the day with beignets and café au lait, with extra points for powdered sugar on everything. As the sun sets, it's time for a drink. And New Orleans does not skimp on options—whether you begin with the Sazerac, the city's signature, or a silky Ramos Gin Fizz. French Quarter bars and moody lounges give every glass a story, and the relaxed attitude here means you can carry yours in a to-go cup.



While New Orleans offers some must-haves and must-dos steeped in culture and history, don't plan a tight schedule. Here, the best stop is usually the one you didn't mean to make.

Plan your holiday at NewOrleans.com